Guide: Becoming a Hindi Spoken Word Artist

1. Build Your Foundation (Months 0-3)

Read widely, and read aloud.

- **Poetry:** Harivansh Rai Bachchan, Dinkar, Nagarjun, Dushyant Kumar, Muktibodh, Agyeya, Kedarnath Singh, Gulzar, Kumar Vishwas (for stage style).
- **Contemporary:** Varun Grover, Piyush Mishra, Neelesh Misra, Puneet Sharma, Hussain Haidry, Aamir Aziz.
- **Prose and drama:** Premchand, Phanishwar Nath Renu, Bhishm Sahni, Mohan Rakesh (Aadhe Adhure), Dharamvir Bharati (Andha Yug), Manto (Urdu in Hindi).
- **Ghazal/Urdu vocabulary:** Learn nuqta and Urdu words so your diction stays precise.
- **Habit:** Read one poem a day aloud and note why it works (imagery, rhythm, pauses).

2. Craft Your Writing (Ongoing)

- Write daily, even 10 minutes. Keep a "diary of lines": overheard phrases, images, emotions.
- Learn forms: muktak, geet, ghazal, nazm, chhand (doha, chaupai), and free verse.
- Spoken word differs from page poetry: use repetition, a strong opening, a turn in the middle, and a punchline or emotional landing.
- Find your themes (identity, small-town life, love, politics, memory, gender, migration) and your own voice instead of imitating others.
- Edit by speaking: cut what trips the tongue.

3. Train Your Voice and Body

- **Voice:** Do pranayama and riyaz; practice breath control, pitch, pace, and volume.
- **Diction:** Practice tongue twisters and clear pronunciation.
- **Theatre skills:** Join a local theatre group or workshop for stage presence, pauses, and emotion.
- **Record yourself** on your phone and review pace, filler words, and energy.

4. Start Performing (Months 3-6)

- Attend open mics (Delhi, Mumbai, Bangalore, Lucknow, Bhopal, Indore and Pune have active scenes). Watch first.
- Perform 2-3 minute pieces. Memorize them well so you can connect with the audience.
- Join communities: Kavi Sammelan circles, college alumni groups, and local Hindi literary societies.
- Seek feedback from a trusted peer or mentor after each performance.

5. Build Your Online Presence

- **YouTube/Instagram Reels:** Post short 30-90 second clips with clean audio.

- Invest in a decent mic (Rs 1,500-3,000 lavalier) and good lighting.
- Add Devanagari captions and hashtags like #HindiPoetry #SpokenWord.
- Consistency (1-2 posts weekly) beats perfection.
- Collaborate with musicians, illustrators, and other poets.

6. Platforms and Opportunities

- **Festivals:** Jaipur Literature Festival, Jashn-e-Rekhta, Sahitya Aaj Tak, Kavi Sammelans.
- **Collectives:** Kommune, Spill Poetry, The Poetry Club, Storytellers' Club, Poetry Adda.
- **Publishing:** Submit to Hindi magazines (Hans, Vagarth, Samalochan, Kritya), websites (Hindwi, Kavita Kosh), and consider a self-published collection.
- **Competitions:** Slam poetry events and college fests.

7. Sustain and Grow (Year 1+)

- **Mentorship:** Approach artists you admire respectfully, and attend their workshops.
- **Develop a signature set:** 5-6 polished pieces of varying moods.
- **Income paths:** Paid gigs, workshops, brand collaborations, audio content (Kuku FM, Pocket FM), scriptwriting, lyrics, and teaching.
- **Protect your work:** Keep dated drafts and credit your pieces when posting.

8. Sample 6-Month Plan

Month	Focus
1	Daily reading and writing; study 5 spoken word performances
2	Write 8 pieces; start voice practice
3	Attend 3 open mics; perform one
4	Join a theatre workshop; start posting clips
5	Perform monthly; collect feedback
6	Build a 10-minute set; pitch to a festival or collective

Mindset Tips

- Expect early stage fright and keep going.
- Don't chase virality at the cost of honesty.
- Your Hindi-English literary grounding is an asset. Code-mixing, done deliberately, can be a style.